



## **INFORMED CONSENT STATEMENT/INFORMATION LETTER**

### **A Study in Decision Making — Main Study**

You are invited to participate in a research study aimed at understanding decision-making in work settings. The study is being conducted by Dr. Christopher Castille (Associate Professor of Management, Principal Investigator), Dr. Ann-Marie R. Castille (Associate Professor of Management, Co-Investigator), Dr. Samantha Falgout (Assistant Professor of Accounting, Co-Investigator), Dr. Kaitlin Gravois (Assistant Professor of Marketing, Co-Investigator), and Dr. Adrien Maught (Assistant Professor of Marketing, Co-Investigator) from Nicholls State University. This study is funded in part by the Nicholls State University Research Council and is part of a larger, multi-site research project coordinated through the Advancement of Replications Initiative in Management (ARIM).

### **Information**

You are invited to participate because you are a student enrolled in a participating Business Administration course at Nicholls State University (for example, BSAD courses) or were otherwise invited to take part in this study. If you agree to participate, you will attend an in-person research session in a campus classroom or laboratory. During the session, you will complete a decision-making task involving anagram puzzles (word puzzles) in a paper workbook. The purpose of this task is to help us understand how people approach decision-making tasks in work settings. You will first complete brief practice rounds to learn the task, then complete several timed performance rounds under instructions assigned to you at random. You will also be asked to complete brief questionnaires about the task, individual difference measures (including personality traits), and basic demographics. After the timed rounds, while the researcher is out of the room, you will privately check your work and complete an anonymous productivity report (you may use your phone only to access an online Scrabble dictionary via a QR code on that report). Participation in this study will take no more than 1 hour to complete. Because understanding the full scientific purpose of the study during the session could influence responses, you will receive a brief written appreciation letter at the end of your session; a complete debriefing explaining the study's purpose and findings will be provided after data collection at Nicholls State University is complete.

## **Risks**

There are no known serious risks associated with participation in this study. The anagram task may cause mild frustration or performance anxiety, but no more than everyday schoolwork or standard puzzles.

## **Benefits**

The researchers cannot guarantee any direct benefits from participation. However, an important contribution of scientific research into organizational behavior is to provide organizations, managers, and employees with data so they can better understand how business and social practices influence employee behavior. In this study, you will be helping us understand the factors that determine employees' decision making and how managers can influence employees' behavior.

## **Confidentiality of Your Information**

Approximately 200 students from Nicholls State University will be invited to complete this study. All data collected will be anonymous. Please do not put any identifying information (e.g., name) on your workbook, productivity report, or survey materials. Signed consent forms will be collected and stored separately from your study materials. Any information that could potentially identify participants will be immediately removed from the data. No information that would potentially identify a participant will be used in the analyses and/or results. Furthermore, because the interest of this study is in the average responses of the entire group of participants, you will not be identified individually in any way in any written reports of this research.

Any raw data will be kept for a period of at least 5 to 7 years per APA guidelines following publication of the research. Paper materials will be stored in a locked office in the Department of Management and Marketing at Nicholls State University. Electronic copies of de-identified data will be stored on secure, password-protected computers maintained by Nicholls State University. Only the researchers affiliated with Nicholls State University conducting this study will have access to the raw data.

Anonymized data related to your participation will be shared with our collaborators at other universities participating in this multi-site project. It will also be stored on the Open Science Framework (OSF), which is an online platform for data storage and management. The OSF is a secure and reputable platform widely used for research data storage and sharing, ensuring compliance with data protection and privacy standards. The data may also be submitted to a peer-reviewed journal (i.e., the data may be publicly available). The data will be completely anonymized prior to submission and will be presented in aggregate form in publications. This process is integral to the research process as it allows other researchers to verify results and avoid

duplicating research. Though the data is posted for the purpose listed, other individuals may access these data by accessing the open access repository. Although the dataset without identifiers may be shared publicly, your identity will always remain confidential. If you have concerns about anonymized data sharing, please discuss them with the researcher before agreeing to participate.

### **Remuneration**

In appreciation of your participation, you will receive a small cash reward of at least \$7.00, with an opportunity to receive up to \$14.00 total depending on the instructions assigned to you during the session and your performance on the anagram task.

At your workstation you will find a sealed cash envelope containing \$14.00 in one-dollar bills. After you complete the timed anagram rounds and brief questionnaires, the researcher will leave the room so you can work privately. You will check your work, complete an anonymous productivity report for the seven scored rounds (round eight does not count toward payment), and take from the cash envelope only the amount specified on that report for your assigned instructions. Place any unearned cash back in the cash envelope, seal the cash envelope and productivity report together in the large envelope provided, and deposit your materials as directed. The research team cannot verify your self-reported performance or link the amount you keep to your identity.

Because payment details depend on your randomly assigned instructions, the specific amount you may keep is stated on your productivity report during the session, not on this consent form.

### **Contact**

This study has been reviewed and received ethics clearance through the Human Subjects Institutional Review Board (HSIRB) at Nicholls State University (Protocol: IRB 2024-07-30-001 CBA). If you have questions for the Board regarding your rights as a research participant, contact the HSIRB Chairperson (Dr. Alaina Daigle, 985-448-4697, [alaina.daigle@nicholls.edu](mailto:alaina.daigle@nicholls.edu)) or your college HSIRB representative at Nicholls State University.

For all other questions, after receiving this letter, or if you would like additional information to assist you in reaching a decision about participation, please contact Dr. Christopher Castille (Principal Investigator) at [christopher.castille@nicholls.edu](mailto:christopher.castille@nicholls.edu).

### **Participation**

Your participation in this study is voluntary. You may decide not to participate or to withdraw from this study at any time by advising the researcher and may do so without penalty. If you withdraw before the private self-payment step, you will receive \$7.00 for your time and your data will be destroyed. If you withdraw after that step, you may keep any cash you already took per the productivity report instructions, but your data will be destroyed. You have the right to skip any question(s)/procedure(s) you choose.

Once you have completed the study, you can no longer withdraw your data, as the data will not be identifiable.

Students who participated in the pilot session may also participate in the main study. Because all data are anonymous, the research team cannot monitor whether the same individual participates in both phases without compromising anonymity.

### **Feedback and Publication**

The results of the study may be submitted to peer-reviewed academic journals for publication consideration and/or be presented at a conference. If you would like a copy of the results, please contact Dr. Christopher Castille (Principal Investigator) at [christopher.castille@nicholls.edu](mailto:christopher.castille@nicholls.edu).

### **CONSENT**

By signing this consent form, you are not waiving your legal rights or releasing the investigator(s) or involved institution(s) from their legal and professional responsibilities.

By signing this form, you agree that you have had the opportunity to ask any questions and receive satisfactory answers.

I agree to participate in this study.

---

Name of Participant

---

Date